

ABITOL

_____Name

_____Date

also called... **hydroabietyl alcohol, dihydroabietyl alcohol, or hydroabietic alcohol.**

What is it?

Abitol is a colorless sticky substance derived from tree sap. It is one component in colophony.

Where might it be found?

Mascara
Adhesive tape
Hypoallergenic tape
Hot-melt adhesives
Inks
Magazine paper
Newsprint
Plasticizer for coatings
Plasticizer for nitrocellulose
Plasticizer for latex rubber
Plasticizer for plastics
Plasticizer for synthetic rubber
Pressure sensitive adhesives
Sealants
Tackifier for emulsions
Tackifier for solvents

Some patients with sensitivity to abitol will also react to **colophony**, also known as **rosin**. Ask your doctor if you show this *cross-reaction* and should also avoid items that contain it.

How to avoid it:

Avoid using any product that contains **abitol**. It is important to check the complete ingredient list on the label of each product you use. If abitol is present, one of its names listed above should appear in the ingredients.

If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or at websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

For possible workplace exposure, check with your safety officer for the complete ingredients of all products encountered.

By reading ingredient labels, you should be able to avoid this allergen and find safe substitutes that are free of it.